

General Terms and Conditions of Use for Aroda Merchant Web and Mobile App

1. Introduction

1.1. "Aroda" is the trading name for Aroda Finance Nigeria Limited, a Nigerian company operating an e-commerce management platform consisting of a web application and mobile app ("platform") together with supporting tools for inventory, orders, finances, marketing, analytics, communication, and staff management for merchants in Nigeria ("territory").

1.2. These general terms and conditions shall apply to all users of the platform, including merchants (owners and staff) and platform admins, and shall govern your use of the platform and related services.

1.3. By using our platform, you accept these general terms and conditions in full. If you disagree with these general terms and conditions or any part of them, you must not use our platform.

1.4. If you use our platform in the course of a business or other organizational project, then by so doing you:

1.4.1. Confirm that you have obtained the necessary authority to agree to these general terms and conditions;

1.4.2. Bind both yourself and the person, company, or other legal entity that operates that business or organizational project to these general terms and conditions; and

1.4.3. Agree that "you" in these general terms and conditions shall reference both the individual user and the relevant person, company, or legal entity unless the context requires otherwise.

2. Registration and Account

2.1. You may not register with our platform if you are under 18 years of age (by using our platform or agreeing to these general terms and conditions, you warrant and represent to us that you are at least 18 years of age).

2.2. If you register for an account with our platform, you will be asked to provide an email address/user ID and password, and you agree to:

2.2.1. Keep your password confidential; and

2.2.3. Be responsible for any activity on our platform arising out of any failure to keep your password confidential, and that you may be held liable for any losses arising out of such a failure.

2.2.4. Your account shall be used exclusively by you and you shall not transfer your account to any third party. If you authorize any third party to manage your account on your behalf, this shall be at your own risk.

2.2.5. We may suspend or cancel your account, and/or edit your account details, at any time in our sole discretion and without notice or explanation, providing that if we cancel any services you have paid for but not received, and you have not breached these general terms and conditions, we will refund you in respect of the same.

2.3. For merchants with staff accounts (via Role-Based Access Control - RBAC), the merchant owner is responsible for inviting staff, assigning roles, and monitoring activity via audit trails. Staff accounts are sub-profiles linked to the main merchant account and must comply with these terms.

You may cancel your account on our platform by contacting us as provided in section 21.

3. Subscriptions and Services

3.1. Aroda offers tiered subscription plans: Basic, Professional, and Enterprise, as detailed on our pricing page. The first month is free with access to all features; subsequent months require payment based on the chosen tier.

3.2. Subscriptions are available on a monthly, quarterly (10% discount), or yearly (20% discount) basis. Payments are processed via integrated gateways.

3.3. By subscribing, you agree to automatic renewals unless cancelled. We may change pricing or features with 30 days' notice; continued use constitutes acceptance.

3.4. Services include but are not limited to: Advanced Product & Inventory Management, Full Order & Escrow Lifecycle Management, Financial Suite, Marketing & CRM, Business Intelligence & Reporting, Real-time Communication & Dispute Handling, and Staff Management.

3.5. Feature access is tier-dependent: Basic for essentials, Professional for advanced tools, Enterprise for unlimited staff and custom integrations. We reserve the right to add, modify, or remove features.

3.6. You warrant that your use of services complies with Nigerian laws. Aroda is not liable for your business operations.

4. Terms and Conditions of Transactions

4.1. You acknowledge and agree that:

4.1.1. The platform provides tools for merchants to manage sales, inventory, orders, and buyer interactions, including escrow for secure transactions;

4.1.2. Aroda facilitates but is not a party to transactions between merchants and buyers (unless specified); and

4.1.3. Transactions are governed by merchant-buyer agreements, with Aroda's escrow ensuring a 24-hour hold for disputes.

4.2. Notwithstanding this, the following provisions apply to all transactions facilitated via the platform:

4.2.1. Prices for products must be as stated in listings and include applicable taxes per Nigerian law;

4.2.2. Delivery, packaging, and extra charges must be clearly stated;

4.2.3. Products must be of satisfactory quality, fit for purpose, and match descriptions;

4.2.4. Merchants warrant good title to products, free from third-party claims, including intellectual property rights;

4.2.5. Escrow funds are held by Aroda and released post-24-hour window unless disputed.

4.3. Merchants must use platform features accurately. Buyers interact via merchant stores; disputes follow our Dispute Resolution Process outlined in section 5.

5. Dispute Resolution, Returns, and Refunds

Disputes, returns, and refunds are managed in accordance with this section, subject to Nigerian consumer laws. Aroda prioritizes trust and fairness in the marketplace.

5.1. Transaction Completion and Escrow Protection

- Buyer discovers a product on the Aroda App and places an order
- Buyer pays the full amount into Aroda's secure escrow system
- Seller receives order notification and prepares the product for shipping
- Seller delivers the product to the buyer
- Upon delivery confirmation, Aroda places the payment on a 24-hour hold post delivery
- The 24-hour post-delivery hold allows the buyer to inspect and assess the product
- If the buyer is satisfied, payment is released to the seller within the 24-hour window
- If the buyer is not satisfied, the buyer may request a return within the 24-hour window
- Return requests must be submitted through the Aroda App dispute interface
- If the buyer does not confirm satisfaction or raise a dispute within 24 hours, the seller is automatically credited
- Escrow ensures funds are protected until the transaction is confirmed

5.2. Raising a Return Request Within the 24-Hour Window

- Buyer may request a return within 24 hours of delivery confirmation
- Return requests must be submitted through the Aroda App dispute interface
- Requests made after the 24-hour window will not be accepted
- The reason for return must be clearly and honestly stated
- Valid dispute conditions include:
 - Wrong product delivered
 - Product not as described
 - Damaged or defective product on delivery
- If no return request is made, escrow funds are released to the seller

5.3. Seller Right to Raise a Dispute

- Seller may raise a dispute within 24 hours of delivery confirmation
- Seller disputes may relate to:
 - False buyer claims
 - Buyer refusal to cooperate
 - Misuse or damage of the product
- Seller must submit disputes through the Aroda App
- Seller must provide clear explanations and supporting evidence
- Escrow funds remain frozen until the dispute is resolved
- Seller cooperation is mandatory during the dispute process

5.4. Product Return Conditions

- Product must be unused, unaltered, and resaleable
- Product must be returned in the same condition as received
- Original packaging, accessories, and all accompanying items must be included
- Products showing signs of misuse, damage, or alteration may be rejected
- Buyer must not use or alter the product while the return is in progress
- Aroda verifies compliance with return conditions before approval

5.5. Product Return Instructions

- Buyer must initiate the return process within 24 hours on the Aroda App
- Buyer must carefully repackage the product to prevent damage in transit
- Return must be shipped using delivery details provided on the Aroda App
- Buyer must upload proof of shipment where required
- Buyer is responsible for all return shipping costs
- Buyer must follow all return instructions provided by Aroda
- Buyer must keep the product safe until the return process is completed

5.6. Aroda Review and Verification

- Aroda reviews all information provided by both parties
- Aroda may request photos, videos, or additional evidence
- Aroda verifies if the return request was submitted within the allowed period
- Aroda confirms whether product condition requirements are met
- Compliance with return conditions is verified before approval
- Aroda assesses disputes based on fairness and platform rules

5.7. Refund Processing

- Approved refunds are processed directly from escrow
- Buyer receives full payment within 48 hours of dispute resolution
- Refunds are credited to the original payment method used
- Buyer is notified once the refund is completed
- Refund processing begins only after return conditions are confirmed
- No further action is required from the buyer

5.8. Seller Protection

- Sellers are protected against late or unfair return claims
- Refunds may be denied if the buyer fails to meet return conditions
- In such cases, escrow funds are released to the seller
- If the dispute is resolved in favour of the seller, payment is transferred
- Seller receives notification once funds are released
- Completed transactions cannot be reopened

5.9. Final Authority

- All return decisions made by Aroda are final and binding
- The process ensures fairness, transparency, and trust
- The system protects both buyers and sellers
- The dispute process is designed to be simple, objective, and efficient

6. Payments and Financial Tools

6.1. Payments for subscriptions and transactions must follow our Payments Guidelines, using approved gateways.

6.2. Merchants link banks via APIs for reconciliation; discrepancies are flagged.

6.3. Payout Wallet: Manual/auto-sweep withdrawals; fees broken down (platform + gateway).

6.4. Tax Management: Auto-calculate based on location; summaries downloadable for FIRS remittance.

6.5. We are not liable for payment failures due to user errors or external issues.

7. Promotions and Marketing

7.1. Promotions via Discount Engine must comply with laws; no deceptive practices.

7.2. Broadcast Messaging to customers is for legitimate updates; spam prohibited.

7.3. We may run platform promotions; terms on our site.

8. Rules About Your Content

8.1. In these terms, "your content" means:

- 8.1.1. All works and materials (text, images, videos, etc.) submitted for listings, chats, or storage;
- 8.1.2. Communications including reviews, feedback, and notes.
- 8.2. Your content must be accurate, complete, and truthful.
- 8.3. Your content must be appropriate, civil, and not:
 - 8.3.1. Offensive, obscene, or explicit;
 - 8.3.2. Violent or gratuitous;
 - 8.3.3. Discriminatory or hateful;
 - 8.3.4. Deceptive or fraudulent;
 - 8.3.5. Spam or annoying.
- 8.4. Your content must not infringe rights, including IP, privacy, or contracts.
- 8.5. No linking to breaching material.
- 8.6. No submission of litigated content.
- 8.7. Reviews must be authentic; no fake ones.
- 8.8. No interference: like off-platform deals, warnings, or collections.

9. Data and Privacy

9.1. Information We Collect

We collect information necessary to provide secure, efficient, and compliant financial and merchant services.

a. Information You Provide

This includes:

- Your full name
- Email address
- Phone number
- Business name
- Store details
- Bank account and payout information
- Government issued identification where required by law
- Login credentials
- Security preferences,
- And any communications with Aroda such as chat messages, support requests, or dispute submissions.

b. Transaction and Business Data

We collect data relating to orders, payments, escrow transactions, payout history, product listings, inventory data, pricing, promotions, tax configuration, financial reports, customer interactions, and dispute records.

c. Automatically Collected Information

This includes device information such as device ID, operating system, browser type, IP address, approximate location, app usage data, system logs, performance metrics, and confirmation of biometric authentication. Raw biometric data is not stored.

9.2. How We Use Your Information

Your information is used to operate and improve Aroda's services. This includes processing payments, holding and releasing escrow funds, verifying identity, preventing fraud, enabling order fulfilment, managing inventory and staff access, generating financial and tax reports, facilitating communication between users, sending service notifications, improving platform performance and security, and complying with legal, regulatory, and tax obligations. We may also use anonymised data for business intelligence, analytics, marketing insights, and service improvements.

9.3. Escrow, Payments, and Financial Data

All payments processed through Aroda are temporarily held in escrow to protect buyers and merchants. Financial information is handled using secure systems and trusted payment and banking partners in line with applicable regulations.

9.4. Staff Accounts and Role Based Access

Merchants may create staff accounts with restricted permissions. Access is limited strictly to assigned roles, and activity logs are maintained to support accountability, transparency, and security.

9.5. Data Sharing and Disclosure

We may share information with trusted service providers, payment processors, logistics partners, or regulatory authorities where legally required. We do not sell personal data. Merchants are required to handle buyer data responsibly. Internal notes such as packaging preferences are for operational use only and must not be misused.

9.6. Data Security

We apply appropriate technical and organisational measures, including encryption, secure authentication, biometric confirmation, device authorisation, and routine security audits. Where a data breach occurs, affected users and relevant authorities will be notified in line with applicable law.

9.7. Data Retention

We retain personal and business data only for as long as necessary to deliver services, meet legal and regulatory requirements, resolve disputes, and enforce platform policies.

9.8. Your Rights and Choices

You have the right to request access to your data, request corrections, request deletion, or close your account, subject to legal and regulatory obligations. You may

opt out of certain data uses, including marketing communications, by contacting info@arodagroup.com.

9.9. Regulatory Compliance

Aroda collects and processes data in accordance with Nigeria Data Protection Commission regulations and other applicable laws.

10. Intellectual Property

10.1. All intellectual property rights in the Aroda platform belong exclusively to Aroda Finance Nigeria Limited. This includes, but is not limited to, the platform design, user interface, software code, escrow mechanisms, transaction timers, dispute tools, logos, trademarks, and all proprietary features.

10.2. Users retain ownership of the content they upload or submit on the platform, including product listings, images, descriptions, and messages. By using the platform, users grant Aroda a non exclusive, royalty free licence to host, display, process, and use such content solely for operating, improving, and promoting the platform.

10.3. No user acquires ownership rights in Aroda's intellectual property. Users must not copy, modify, distribute, sell, lease, reverse engineer, decompile, or otherwise exploit any part of the platform without Aroda's prior written consent.

11. Limitation of Liability

11.1. Aroda provides its services on an "as is" and "as available" basis, subject only to warranties required by applicable Nigerian law.

11.2. Aroda is not liable for indirect, incidental, consequential, or special losses, including loss of profits, data, business opportunities, or goodwill.

11.3. Aroda is not responsible for actions or omissions of buyers, sellers, logistics providers, payment partners, or other third parties.

11.4. To the extent permitted by law, Aroda's total liability to any user is limited to the subscription or service fees paid by that user to Aroda within the relevant claim period.

12. Indemnity

12.1. Users agree to indemnify and hold Aroda harmless against all claims, losses, damages, liabilities, costs, and expenses arising from their breach of these policies, misuse of the platform, violation of laws, or infringement of third party rights.

12.2. This obligation survives termination of the user's account.

13. Disputes Outside the Platform

13.1. Transactions and disputes must be handled exclusively through the Aroda App.

13.2. Aroda is not responsible for disputes, losses, or agreements conducted outside the platform.

13.3. Any off platform dealings are undertaken at the user's own risk and void platform protections.

14. Breaches and Enforcement

14.1. Aroda may suspend, restrict, or terminate user accounts for policy violations, fraud, misuse, or unlawful activity.

14.2. Aroda may withhold escrow funds during investigations.

14.3. Users in breach are not entitled to refunds, credits, or compensation.

15. Force Majeure

15.1. Aroda is not liable for failure or delay caused by events beyond its reasonable control, including natural disasters, strikes, power failures, network outages, government actions, or system disruptions.

15.2. Services will resume as soon as reasonably practicable.

16. Assignment

16.1. Aroda may assign or transfer its rights and obligations under this policy without restriction.

16.2. Users may not assign their rights or obligations without Aroda's prior written consent.

17. Severability

17.1. If any provision of this policy is held invalid or unenforceable, it will be severed.

17.2. The remaining provisions remain fully effective.

18. Third Party Rights

18.1. This policy does not grant any rights to third parties.

18.2. Only Aroda and its users may enforce these terms.

19. Entire Agreement

19.1. This policy, together with other Aroda policies, constitutes the entire agreement between Aroda and users.

19.2. It supersedes all prior agreements, understandings, or communications.

20. Law and Jurisdiction

20.1. This policy is governed by the laws of the Federal Republic of Nigeria.

20.2. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts in Abuja.

21. Variations

21.1. Aroda may amend this policy from time to time.

21.2. Updates will be communicated via the app or email. Continued use of the platform constitutes acceptance.

22. Company Details

22.1. Aroda Finance Nigeria Limited, Abuja, Nigeria.

22.2. Contact: info@arodagroup.com